

The Olympic Games began as athletic festivals to honor the Greek gods. The most important festival was held in the valley of Olympia to honor Zeus, the king of the gods. It was this festival that became the Olympic Games **in 776 B.C.** These games were ended **in A.D. 394** by the Roman Emperor who ruled Greece. No Olympic games were held **for more than 1,500 years.** Then the modern Olympics began **in 1896.** Almost 300 male athletes competed in the first modern Olympics. In the games held **in 1900,** female athletes were allowed to compete. The games have continued **every four years since 1896** except **during World War II,** and they will most likely continue **for many years to come.**

Patrón: **Secuencia cronológica**

Idea principal: Los Juegos Olímpicos se iniciaron en la antigüedad, luego se interrumpieron por muchos años hasta que se reanudaron en el siglo XIX.

The modern Olympics are **very unlike** the ancient Olympic Games. Individual events are **different.** **While** there were no swimming races in the ancient games, for example, there were chariot races. There were no female contestants and all athletes competed in the nude. Of course, the ancient and modern Olympics are also **alike** in many ways. Some events, such as the javelin and discus throws, are **the same.** Some people say that cheating, professionalism, and nationalism in the modern games are a disgrace to the Olympic tradition. But according to the ancient Greek writers, there were many cases of cheating, nationalism, and professionalism in their Olympics **too.**

Patrón: **Comparación (Diferencias y similitudes)**

Idea principal: Existen varias similitudes y diferencias entre los Juegos Olímpicos modernos y los antiguos.

There are **several reasons** why so many people attend the Olympic Games or watch them on television. **One reason** is tradition. The name Olympics and the torch and flame remind people of the ancient games. People can escape the ordinariness of daily life by attending or watching the Olympics. They like to identify with someone else's individual sacrifice and accomplishment. National pride is **another reason,** and an athlete's or a team's hard earned victory becomes a nation's victory. There are national medal counts and people keep track of how many medals their country's athletes have won.

Patrón: **Causa-efecto / Listado** (en este caso hay un patrón adentro de otro: un **listado** de causas)

Idea principal: Existen diversas razones/causas por las cuales tanta gente va a los Juegos Olímpicos o los mira por televisión.